PHL 130: Introduction to Ethics

Spring 2027. Monday and Wednesday, 3:00-4:20 PM. Week 1 begins Monday, January 11, 2027. Spring break is the week after Week 8, so Week 9 begins on March 15.

Deadlines

Paper 1 is due Friday of Week 4 by 5 PM. Paper 2 is due Friday of Week 10 by 5 PM.

Short reflection journals are due by 11:59 PM on the Sunday at the end of Weeks 2, 5, 7, 11 and 13.

The midterm is in class on Wednesday of Week 7. The final paper is due at the start of our last class meeting, Wednesday of Week 16.

Course materials

The required textbook is available at the campus bookstore and as an e-book. Lecture slides are posted on D2L after each class. You will also need a calculator for some assignments and all exams. The required textbook is available at the campus bookstore and as an e-book. Lecture slides are posted on D2L after each class. You will also need a calculator for some assignments and all exams.

Grading scale

4.0: 90-100%, 3.5: 85-89%, 3.0: 80-84%, 2.5: 75-79%, 2.0: 70-74%, 1.5: 65-69%, 1.0: 60-64%, 0.0: below 60%. Grades are not curved, and extra credit is not offered. 4.0: 90-100%, 3.5: 85-89%, 3.0: 80-84%, 2.5: 75-79%, 2.0: 70-74%, 1.5: 65-69%, 1.0: 60-64%, 0.0: below 60%. Grades are not curved, and extra credit is not offered.

Technology

Bring a laptop or tablet to class when the schedule says so. If you don't have one, the library lends them for the semester. Report technical problems to the help desk before the deadline, not after. Bring a laptop or tablet to class when the schedule says so. If you don't have one, the library lends them for the semester. Report technical problems to the help desk before the deadline, not after.

Mental health

College can be stressful. Counseling and Psychiatric Services offers free and confidential support. If you are struggling, please reach out to them or to me; I will help you find the right resources. College can be stressful. Counseling and Psychiatric Services offers free and confidential support. If you are struggling, please reach out to them or to me; I will help you find the right resources.

Title IX

Instructors are required to report incidents of sexual misconduct to the Office of Institutional Equity. Confidential resources are available through the Center for Survivors and the counseling center. Instructors are required to report incidents of sexual misconduct to the Office of Institutional Equity. Confidential resources are available through the Center for Survivors and the counseling center.

Religious observance

If a religious holiday conflicts with an assignment or exam, let me know during the first two weeks of class so that we can arrange an alternative. If a religious holiday conflicts with an assignment or exam, let me know during the first two weeks of class so that we can arrange an alternative.

Attendance

Attendance is expected at every class meeting. If you must miss class for an illness or a university-sanctioned activity, email the instructor before class when possible. Repeated absences will make it difficult to succeed in this course, because much of the material is introduced only in class.

Academic integrity

Article 2.III.B.2 of the Student Rights and Responsibilities states that the student shares with the faculty the responsibility for maintaining the integrity of scholarship, grades, and professional standards. You may discuss ideas with classmates, but the work you submit must be your own. Using AI tools to write answers you submit is not allowed unless an assignment says otherwise.

Accommodations

If you have a documented disability and need accommodations, contact the Resource Center for Persons with Disabilities (RCPD) and share your Verified Individualized Services and Accommodations (VISA) form with the instructor within the first two weeks of the semester.

Late work

Late work is accepted up to 48 hours after the deadline with a 10% penalty per day. Work more than 48 hours late receives no credit unless an extension was arranged in advance. Technology problems are not an excuse, so submit early and keep copies of your files.

Communication

Announcements are posted on D2L. Check D2L and your MSU email at least once a day. Questions about the material are best asked in office hours or on the course discussion board, where classmates can benefit from the answers too.